

com, you will get a prompt that says you have to make future purchases in USD. Don't worry about this for now. Fire up the Alexa app, go to **Settings**

> **Music & Podcasts** >

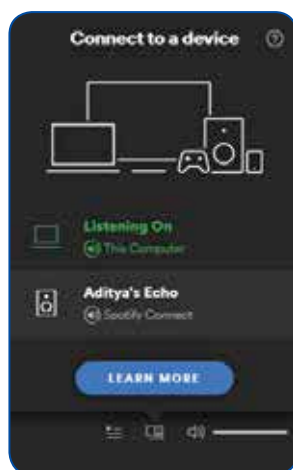
Link New Service and select **Spotify**. Now you have to login to Spotify. Go to **Settings** > **Default Services** and change **Music** and **Artists and Genre Stations** to **Spotify**. Now

you are all good to go, just say "Spotify play xyz playlist", and Spotify will start playing the playlist from your library. Make sure to give your playlists easy to understand names for Alexa, so something like "fantasy" works better than "npr 2012". We would not recommend this approach for getting Spotify to work with Alexa though, because although you can easily switch back to India region, it messes up other integrations and custom skills. However, once you have switched back and forth between countries, Amazon saves the address information, so moving between regions is just a matter of a few clicks. Do remember though, you have to use the .com domain to switch to .in and the .in domain to switch to .com.

If you actually go through the trouble of switching regions to US, integrating Spotify, and switching back to India region, the Echo remains an option as an available device on the Spotify apps across smartphones, desktop and web, which means there is no need to play via Bluetooth, the device connects to Spotify through WiFi. But, at this point, Alexa still won't play a playlist from Spotify on command. If you are a Spotify subscriber, and want to ask Spotify to support Alexa integration in India, follow this link (<https://dgit.in/alxsptfy>) and click on **Me Too**.

PAIR CALENDAR WITH ALEXA

Go to **Settings** > **Calendars** > **Google**. Next, sign in with your Google account and you should be done. If you have multiple calendars on the same account, tap on the Google icon again and you will get a list of all available



Using the Echo on Spotify Connect

calendars. Uncheck the ones that you do not want Alexa to access. You can ask Alexa to read out upcoming events, or add events to the calendar. Note that any events added to the calendar will be in Alexa's copy of the calendar, and will not be added to the Google Calendar, and will not be accessible in the web or app versions of Google Calendar.

A similar procedure can be used to link Microsoft and Apple calendars as well. Note that anyone else who has access to the Echo will also have access to any linked calendars. If multiple people link their calendars to Echo, then Alexa will read out upcoming events from all linked calendars when prompted. Also, Amazon stores a copy of the linked calendar on its own servers, instead of pulling the information from the linked service on demand.

CREATE YOUR OWN ROUTINE

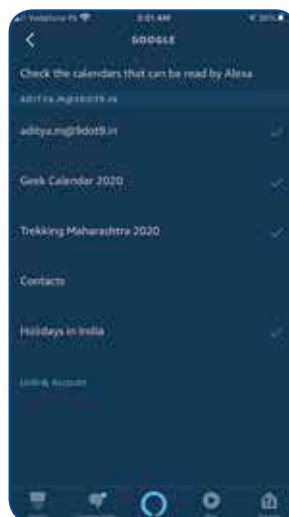
Creating a routine is the first step towards customising your Alexa experience, and allows you to perform a series of tasks given a particular trigger. Essentially, it is a version of IFTTT for capabilities of the Echo. Go to **Settings** > **Routines**. Tap on the + sign and enter a routine name. Let's go with **morning briefing**. Then tap the + sign next to **When this happens**, tap on **Voice** and enter a phrase. Let's go with **good morning**. Now, tap the + sign next to **Add action** and select **Calendar** then **Today's Calendar**. Add another

action, tap on **Calendar** and select **Next Event**. Then, add the **Weather**, **News** and **Traffic** options. We suggest you skip the **News** here because the anchors in most local providers tend to yell at you, which is not really the first tone of voice you want to hear in the morning. **Flash Briefing** can be customised in the global settings, where you can pick and chain multiple providers depending on your interest areas. So you can add Economic Times, Major-Geeks, and SpeakingTree to the Flash Briefing. You can then drag and drop to reorder all these actions according to your preferences. If you want to start your day with some music, you can add the Music action. Select **Morning** in the play section, as most services have a morning playlist. Tap on the **Timer** button and select **30 minutes**. Now, choose the device, and tap

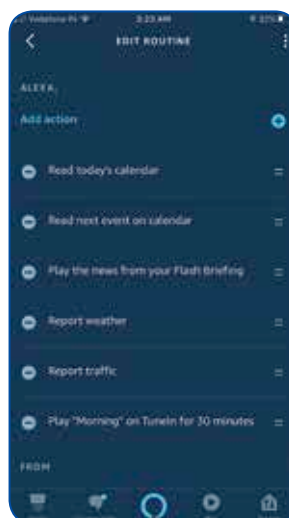
on **Save**. Note that the **Traffic** option will only work if you have set your home and office location in the app. If you have not previously set your home and office addresses, you will get a notification on your Alexa app that allows you to put in these locations. You have successfully configured Alexa for a great way to start off your day. Now, let us create another routine, just for fun, called **intruder alert**. Tap on **When this happens**, then on **Voice** and key in, **intruder alert**. Now tap on **Add action**, go to **Sounds**, then go to **Sci-Fi** and tap on **Red alert**. Now choose the device and tap on **Save**.

USE AN IFTTT APPLET

While skills are one way to increase the capabilities of your Echo, another way is to connect to IFTTT applets. We will be using one here known as **call my device**, which can be



Linking calendars to Alexa



Creating a custom routine